

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

- Answer Choices:
- A. visual system
 - B. thalamus
 - C. frontal lobe
 - D. brain stem
 - E. parietal lobe
 - F. cerebellum
 - G. cortex
 - H. basal ganglia
 - I. hypothalamus
 - J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
the brain develops in stages , with the least developed part at birth being the cortex , which is responsible for higher-level thinking , decision-making , and complex behaviors .
the prefrontal cortex , a part of the cortex , is particularly immature at birth , and continues to develop throughout childhood and adolescence .
the other options are either more developed at birth or are critical for basic functions that are present at birth .
the visual system is relatively well-developed at birth , allowing newborns to detect light and respond to visual stimuli .
the brain stem and hypothalamus control basic life functions such as breathing , heart rate , and body temperature , and are more developed at birth .
the basal ganglia and thalamus are also more developed at birth , playing roles in movement control and sensory processing , respectively .
the limbic system , which includes the hippocampus and amygdala , is more developed at birth , involved in emotions , motivation , and memory .
the parietal lobe , involved in spatial awareness and processing , is also more developed at birth .
the cerebellum , responsible for motor coordination and balance , is more developed at birth .
the cortex , specifically the prefrontal cortex , is the least developed part of the brain at birth .
</think>

<answer> G . cortex </answer>

